DIGITAL ASSETS EXECUTIVE INDUSTRY UPDATE

THIRD QUARTER 2026

The Cash Leg

Stablecoins, tokenized deposits, custody and cross-border payments as the rulebook takes effect

Payment stablecoins now sit inside a federal United States statute that takes effect on January 18, 2027, without its implementing rules. Europe has closed its authorization window, Hong Kong has licensed two issuers and signaled it will license few more, and the Bank of England has quietly softened a position the market had already priced in. This report sets out what the measured evidence supports, what it does not, and the six decisions a board should reach before the statute is live.

Al-Mabrook Financial Inc. | August 2026

About this report

The *Digital Assets Executive Industry Update* is published quarterly by Al-Mabrook Financial Inc. for boards, asset-liability committees, treasury and payments leadership, general counsel, risk officers and digital-product teams at banks, exchanges, asset managers and Islamic financial institutions. It is written for readers who must make capital and licensing decisions on a schedule, not for readers following price.

This is the third-quarter 2026 edition. It covers the period from the enactment of the GENIUS Act in July 2025 through August 30, 2026, and looks forward to the statute's effective date of January 18, 2027 and the United Kingdom's regime commencement in October 2027.

Every quantitative claim in this report carries a source and an as-of date. Where reputable houses publish materially different figures for the same measure, this report shows the range and names the basis of measurement rather than selecting the most favorable number. Twelve exhibits are included; each carries its own source line. A note on method, including the three measurement conflicts that most affect this subject, appears on page 31.

Section 10 addresses the Islamic finance dimension of this subject, which is material to a growing share of the institutions this report is written for and which is governed, at present, by no standard at all. That section is expressly not a Shariah opinion, and the notice below applies to it in full.

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In brief

01 The United States will operate under a live stablecoin statute with unfinished rules.

GENIUS takes effect on January 18, 2027. Regulators missed the July 2026 rulemaking deadline, and missing it does not extend the clock.

02 Custody became economically viable in January 2025, not this year.

Staff Accounting Bulletin 122 removed the balance-sheet gross-up nineteen months ago. Institutions that date the change to 2026 have understated their own runway.

03 Stablecoin supply has contracted for the first time since 2022.

Float peaked at $321 billion in May 2026 and stood at $305 billion on August 30. Supply is not a one-way ratchet.

04 Ninety-three percent of on-chain stablecoin volume is not a payment.

Of $62 trillion in gross 2025 transfers, $4.2 trillion survives adjustment and $350 to $550 billion is genuine real-economy payment.

05 The cost advantage in remittances is corridor-specific, and it has now been measured.

The Banca d'Italia shopped 200 stablecoin transfers across ten corridors and found end-to-end costs from 0.3% to almost 9%, not systematically cheaper than incumbents.

06 The contested ground is no longer whether to tokenize. It is whose money settles.

Securities issuance works. Atomic delivery against payment does not, unless the cash sits on the same ledger. Every serious program now has a money strategy.

> "Regulation is a product constraint, not a press release cycle."

SIX DECISIONS

1. Issue, distribute, or accept and custody?
2. Are tokenized deposits the wholesale strategy?
3. Where does custody sit?
4. Which corridors survive measured economics?
5. Are tokenized funds collateral or a product?
6. For Islamic institutions, what governs in the absence of a standard?

Executive summary

The industry has stopped arguing about the destination and started arguing about the ledger

Eighteen months ago the open question was whether regulated institutions would be permitted to participate at all. That is now settled in every market that matters. The question in the third quarter of 2026 is narrower and more expensive: when a tokenized security settles, whose money moves against it.

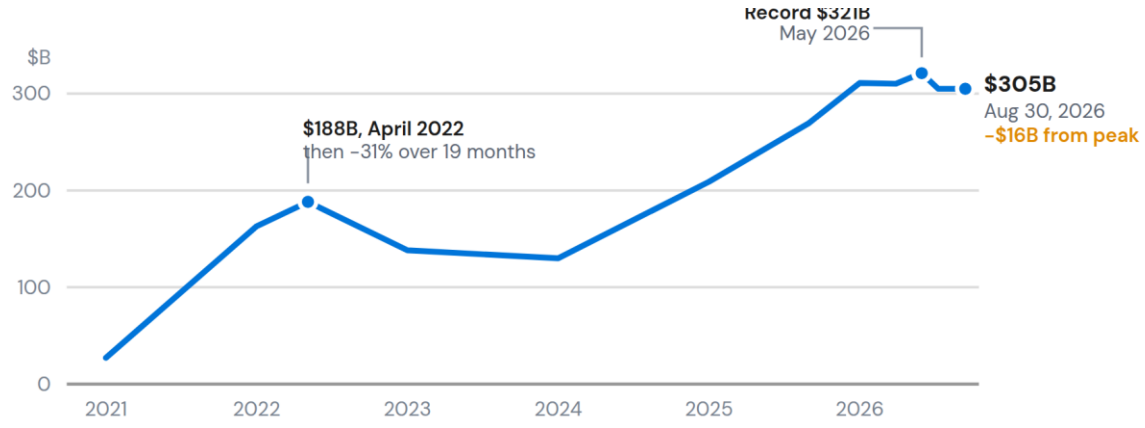
Payment stablecoins acquired a federal statutory basis in the United States on July 18, 2025.[1] The implementing rules that statute called for were not finalized by the deadline Congress set, and the effective date does not move as a consequence. GENIUS takes effect on January 18, 2027 whether or not the rules exist, which means American institutions will spend the first part of next year operating a licensed activity under proposals rather than final regulations. That is an unusual position, and it belongs in every vendor contract signed between now and then.

Europe closed its service-provider authorization window on July 1, 2026, though the more consequential date passed eighteen months earlier, when non-compliant tokens came off exchange order books. Hong Kong licensed two issuers in April 2026 and has told its legislature the number will stay very limited, having received thirty-six applications.[2] The Bank of England dropped the per-holder caps the market had objected to and softened backing to 30 percent central-bank deposits.

EXHIBIT E1

Supply Has Contracted for the First Time Since the Terra Collapse

Total stablecoin market capitalization, $ billions, year-end unless noted



Sources: DefiLlama; CoinGecko 2025 Annual and Q1–Q2 2026 Crypto Reports; Transak; Al-Mabrook analysis.

Note: Year-end values for 2021 through 2023 rest on secondary compilation and should be treated as indicative. The April 2022 peak and all 2025–2026 points are from primary trackers.

$305B

Total stablecoin supply on August 30, 2026, down $16 billion from the May record.
DefiLlama.

Two rails are forming, and the official sector has picked one

Non-bank and specially chartered payment stablecoins are winning cross-border speed and emerging-market distribution. Incumbent banks are answering with tokenized commercial-bank deposits, which stay on the issuing bank's balance sheet and carry a deposit-insurance analysis that follows the deposit rather than the token format. At Jackson Hole on August 28, 2026, the General Manager of the Bank for International Settlements argued that stablecoins in their current form fail as a means of payment at scale on four counts, and that everyday payments belong on tokenized deposits anchored in central-bank money.[3]

Read this as a policy signal, not a market forecast. Private rails continue to scale while official doctrine hardens around the two-tier system. Both are true at once, and a strategy assuming only one will be wrong within eighteen months.

The volume number in most board packs is the wrong number

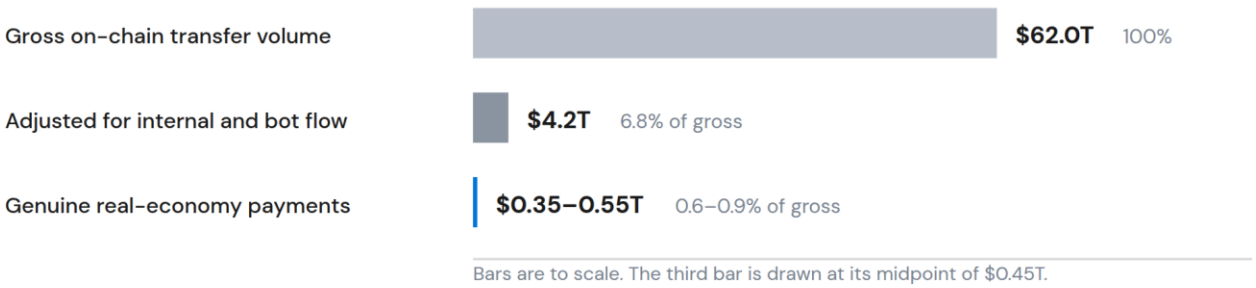
On-chain stablecoin transfer volume reached $62 trillion in 2025 on a gross basis, and that figure has been quoted in support of capital allocation decisions. When BCG and Allium filtered the same year for internal transfers, exchange rebalancing and automated flow, $4.2 trillion survived. Isolating genuine real-economy payment left $350 to $550 billion.[4] The gap between the headline and the number reflecting someone actually paying for something is a factor of roughly 130.

A corridor business underwritten against gross volume will be sized wrong by two orders of magnitude, and the error is discoverable by anyone who reads the white paper. Present adjusted volume and name the adjustment. Section 8 sets out the posture this evidence supports.

EXHIBIT E2

Ninety-Three Percent of Adjusted Stablecoin Volume Is Not a Payment

Stablecoin transfer volume, 2025, three successive definitions



Bars are to scale. The third bar is drawn at its midpoint of $0.45T.

Source: BCG and Allium, *Stablecoin Payments: The Truth Behind the Numbers*, January 2026.

Note: The adjusted figure removes internal transfers, exchange rebalancing and automated flow. The paper also notes that most trading activity occurs off-chain and is therefore unobservable in either measure.

> "The gap between the headline number and genuine payment volume is a factor of roughly 130."

01

The market

In this part · 1. What the numbers say, and what they count · Exhibits 1, 2 and 3

Section 1

What the numbers say, and what they count

The total capitalization of the cryptoasset market was $2.71 trillion on August 30, 2026, down roughly 29 percent over twelve months, with bitcoin at 58 percent of the total and ether at 11 percent.[5] That contraction is the context in which every figure in this section should be read. Stablecoin supply, tokenized asset value and institutional allocation intent have all grown through a market that has fallen for three consecutive quarters, which is a more interesting fact about the sector than any of the growth rates taken alone.

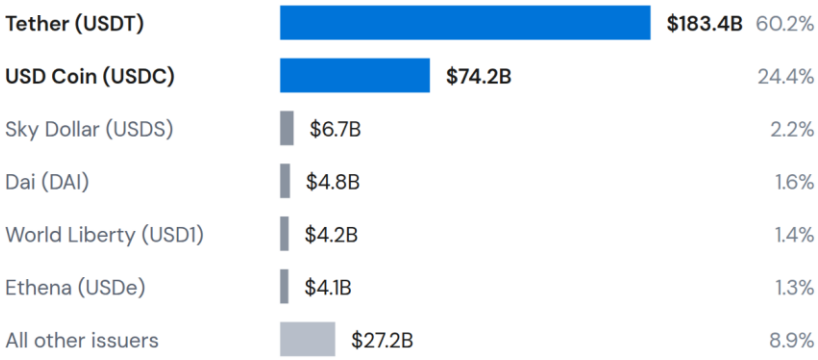
Stablecoin supply stood at $305 billion. Two issuers account for approximately 85 percent of it. Tether's USDT holds 60.2 percent of the market and Circle's USDC holds 24.4 percent, a concentration that has increased rather than diminished as the regulatory perimeter has tightened. The remaining 15 percent is spread across more than thirty issuers, none of which holds more than 2.2 percent.

Concentration of this degree is a supervisory fact before it is a competitive one. A regulated institution accepting client stablecoin balances is, in practice, accepting concentrated exposure to two reserve managers with different domiciles, different disclosure regimes and different attestation practices. The GENIUS permitted-issuer perimeter will change the identity of the issuers rather than the shape of the distribution.

EXHIBIT 1

Two Issuers Hold Eighty-Five Percent of Stablecoin Supply

Stablecoin market capitalization by issuer, $ billions and percentage of total, August 30, 2026



Source: DefiLlama; Al-Mabrook analysis.

Note: "All other issuers" comprises more than thirty tokens and includes BlackRock's BUIDL, which DefiLlama classifies as a stablecoin and which most real-world-asset trackers classify as a tokenized money market fund.

84.6%

Combined share of stablecoin supply held by USDT and USDC, on both DefiLlama and Artemis measures. August 30, 2026.

Section 1 · continued

One year, five numbers

Five reputable organizations published a figure for 2025 stablecoin transfer volume. They range from $62 trillion to $0.45 trillion. All five are defensible, and all five measure something different, which makes the choice of figure an editorial decision rather than a factual one.

The practical rule is that the number should match the question. If the question is how much settlement traffic the network carries, gross volume answers it. If the question is how large the addressable payments business is, only the bottom two figures are relevant, and the difference between them is the difference between a plausible business case and an implausible one.

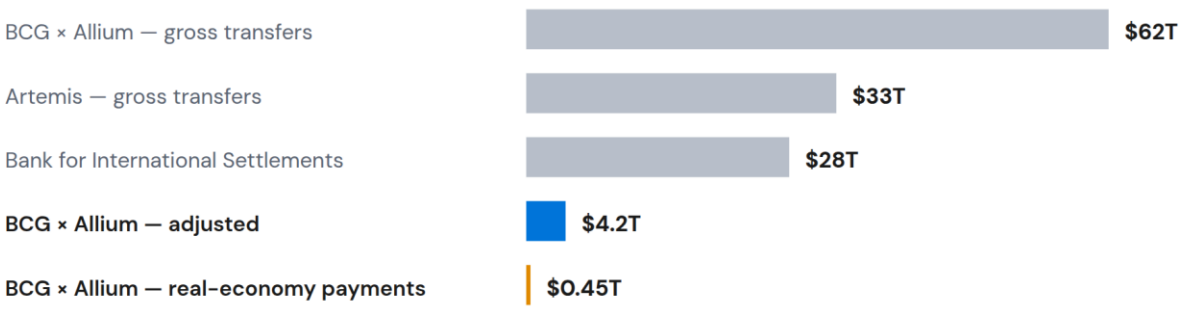
The adjustment is not a matter of judgment or presentation. Gross on-chain volume counts the same dollar every time it moves, and a dollar of stablecoin moves many times: between an exchange's own wallets as it rebalances, between market-making bots, in and out of automated liquidity pools, and back again. Filtering those flows is a mechanical exercise on public data, which is why several organizations have now done it and arrived at answers within the same order of magnitude.

The distance between $62 trillion and $4.2 trillion is therefore not a disagreement between analysts. It is the difference between counting transfers and counting transactions, and an institution that quotes the first figure to a supervisor should expect to be asked which one it meant.

EXHIBIT 2

The Same Year, Measured Five Ways

Stablecoin transfer volume for calendar 2025, $ trillions, by publishing organization and basis



Sources: BCG and Allium, January 2026; Artemis; Bank for International Settlements; Al-Mabrook analysis.

MEASUREMENT NOTE

Do not plot Artemis and Visa–Allium volume on the same line. The Visa–Allium filter is roughly four times stricter, so a series that switches between them will show a collapse that did not happen.

A NOTE ON THE ACH COMPARISON

The claim that stablecoins surpassed the Automated Clearing House in February 2026 rests on an ACH figure of $6.8 trillion for the month.

Nacha's own published statistics imply $8.3 to $8.6 trillion a month across the first half of 2026. The comparison is basis-dependent and should be footnoted wherever it is used.

Section 1 · continued

Where the payments actually are

Within the $350 to $550 billion of genuine real-economy payment, business-to-business flow is the largest segment at $150 to $230 billion, followed by consumer-to-consumer remittances and consumer-to-business payments at $90 to $130 billion each. Business-to-consumer flow, largely payroll and marketplace payouts, accounts for the remainder.

Consumer-to-consumer is growing fastest at roughly 75 percent a year, and it is also the segment with the most competition and the thinnest margin. Business-to-business is where the arithmetic is most favorable, because corporate treasurers already absorb multi-day settlement and wide foreign-exchange spreads as an unavoidable cost of doing business. The segment with the worst incumbent experience is the segment where a new rail has the least to prove.

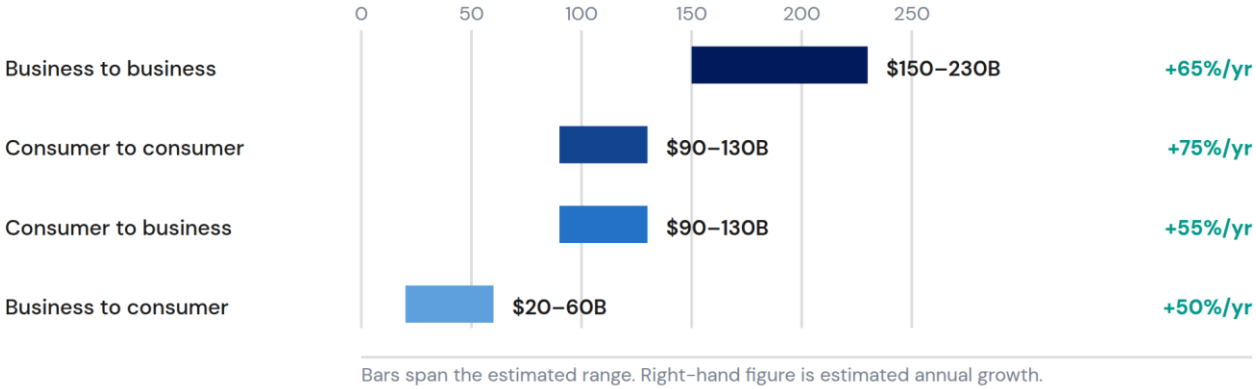
Two features of this distribution deserve attention. The first is that all four segments are growing at between 50 and 75 percent a year, which is unusual: in most payment markets one segment carries the growth while the others are flat. The second is that the total remains small enough that a single large corporate program can move a segment's reported number, so year-over-year growth rates in this data should be read as directional rather than precise.

For an institution deciding where to run a first corridor, the implication is that segment choice matters less than counterparty choice. A treasury relationship with an existing corporate client that already pays into a slow corridor is a better starting point than any of these four categories considered in the abstract.

EXHIBIT 3

Business-to-Business Flow Is the Largest Real-Economy Segment and the Least Contested

Estimated 2025 real-economy stablecoin payment volume by flow type, $ billions



Bars span the estimated range. Right-hand figure is estimated annual growth.

Source: BCG and Allium, *Stablecoin Payments: The Truth Behind the Numbers*, January 2026.

0.7%

Share of 2025 gross on-chain stablecoin volume that represented a genuine real-economy payment.
BCG and Allium, January 2026.

02

The rulebook

Six jurisdictions, one clock, and two dates that are routinely misstated in board materials.

In this part · 2. The regulatory map · 3. The United States institutional stack · Exhibit 4

Section 2

The regulatory map: the Americas and Europe

For a cross-border franchise the question is no longer whether an activity is permitted but which license it requires, what reserve composition it mandates, how fast redemption must clear, and which anti-money-laundering stack satisfies the examiner. Two developments have changed the character of this map during 2026. The United States now has a statute whose rules are unwritten, and the United Kingdom has moved toward the market rather than away from it.

The British reversal deserves more attention than it has received. Between the November 2025 consultation and the June 2026 policy statement the Bank of England abandoned individual and business holding caps entirely, replaced them with a temporary issuance guardrail set at the level of the coin rather than the holder, cut the unremunerated central-bank deposit requirement from 40 percent to 30, and permitted loyalty and activity-based rewards that it had previously treated as interest by another name. An institution whose sterling plans were shelved on the strength of the consultation should reopen them.

JURISDICTION	STATUS AT AUGUST 30, 2026	PRACTICAL IMPLICATION
United States GENIUS Act; CLARITY Act; SEC custody modernization	Statute enacted July 18, 2025. Implementing rules missed the July 2026 deadline; the effective date remains **January 18, 2027**. The joint customer-identification proposal closed for comment on August 21, 2026. CLARITY passed the House in July 2025; the Senate has not passed it. The custody rule reached OIRA on August 25, 2026 at proposal stage.	Build to the statute: full liquid reserves, monthly attested disclosure, no holder interest, permitted-issuer perimeter. Do not assume CLARITY passes this Congress, and do not sign a vendor agreement without a re-trade provision running through January 2027.
European Union MiCA	Stablecoin titles in force since June 30, 2024. Non-compliant tokens were delisted in the first quarter of 2025. July 1, 2026 was the backstop for service-provider authorization; Germany, Ireland, Lithuania, Austria and Slovakia closed grandfathering at the end of 2025. Euro stablecoin float remains near $0.8 billion, about 0.3 percent of the global total.	Distribution requires both an authorized token issuer and an authorized service provider. Qivalis, a thirty-seven-bank consortium operating under a Dutch e-money license, is the incumbent answer and is targeting the second half of 2026.
United Kingdom Bank of England; FCA	Policy statement and draft code published **June 22, 2026**. The proposed per-holder caps were dropped in favor of a temporary £40 billion issuance guardrail per systemic coin. Backing moved to 30 percent unremunerated central-bank deposits and 70 percent short-term gilts. Holder interest remains prohibited; loyalty and activity-based rewards are now permitted. Code finalization is targeted for the end of 2026.	A systemic sterling coin will resemble a narrow bank more than a fintech product. Plan two tracks. The FCA gateway opens September 30, 2026 and the broader regime applies from **October 25, 2027**.

Nothing in this table is settled enough to build a five-year plan against. All of it is settled enough to build an operating model against, which is the distinction that matters for a decision taken this quarter.

Section 2 · continued

Asia-Pacific and the watch list

JURISDICTION	STATUS AT AUGUST 30, 2026	PRACTICAL IMPLICATION
Hong Kong Stablecoins Ordinance	In force August 1, 2025. The Monetary Authority licensed its first two issuers on **April 10, 2026**: HSBC, and Anchorpoint Financial, a joint venture of Standard Chartered Hong Kong, Animoca Brands and HKT. Thirty-six applications were received. In a June 2026 reply to the Legislative Council the Authority stated it has no settled view on further licensing and that the eventual total will remain very limited. Two licenses stand at the end of August.	Issuance in Asia is a licensed, banking-adjacent business behind a deliberately narrow door. Pair any ambition with Securities and Futures Commission dealing and custody permissions rather than assuming a license is obtainable.
Singapore and Japan MAS framework; Payment Services Act	Singapore requires redemption at par within five business days with prescribed reserve composition and audit. Japan restricts issuance of licensed electronic payment instruments to banks, trust banks and funds-transfer providers. The Financial Services Agency **removed the ¥1 million per-transaction cap** on second-type providers effective August 24, 2026, and created a dedicated stablecoin division on August 7.	The preferred domicile pair for Asian institutional product. Japan's cap removal, rather than the still-small ¥2.8 billion JPYC float, is the change that makes institutional yen settlement possible.
Brazil Resolutions BCB 521 and 561	From **October 2026**, Resolution BCB 561 bars payment institutions operating under the electronic foreign-exchange framework from settling with overseas counterparties in stablecoins or cryptoassets. This is a channel restriction rather than a general prohibition. Licensed virtual-asset service providers retain a supervised pathway under Resolution BCB 521, which took full effect on May 4, 2026.	The corridor is constrained by license type, not closed. Every corridor income statement needs a kill switch, an alternative rail and a license-migration option, and the team needs to know who is authorized to use them.

FROM THE SUPERVISOR'S SEAT

The Hong Kong reply to the Legislative Council repays reading in full. A regulator that has just opened a regime and immediately signals it will grant very few licenses is managing a different risk from the one its applicants are managing. Thirty-six firms applied; two hold a license.

The Brazilian measure repays close reading because its structure is likely to be copied. A regulator that wants to constrain stablecoin settlement without prohibiting it can decline to permit it in one licensing channel while allowing it in another, which achieves the supervisory objective and leaves a

compliant path open. Corridor strategy that treats regulation as binary will misread this kind of intervention in both directions.

The Asian jurisdictions have converged on a similar instinct from the opposite direction. Hong Kong wrote a full licensing regime and then granted two licenses out of thirty-six applications. Singapore set a five-business-day redemption obligation and prescribed the reserve. Japan restricted issuance to entities that were already prudentially supervised and then, in August 2026, removed the transaction cap that had made the licensed product commercially useless. In each case the regime is open in principle and narrow in practice, and the binding constraint on a market-entry plan is the supervisor's appetite rather than the statute's text.

Section 3

The United States institutional stack: four tracks, one clock

Four tracks determine whether a regulated American institution can hold, move and report digital assets at scale. They are converging on the same eighteen-month window, and only one of them has a fixed date.

Payment stablecoins. GENIUS takes effect January 18, 2027 with rules at proposal stage.

Custody. Staff Accounting Bulletin 121 has been gone since January 2025. Comptroller of the Currency letters 1170, 1183 and 1184 permit national-bank custody, execution at customer direction and sub-custody. The Commission's custody rule reached regulatory review on August 25, 2026, still at proposal stage.

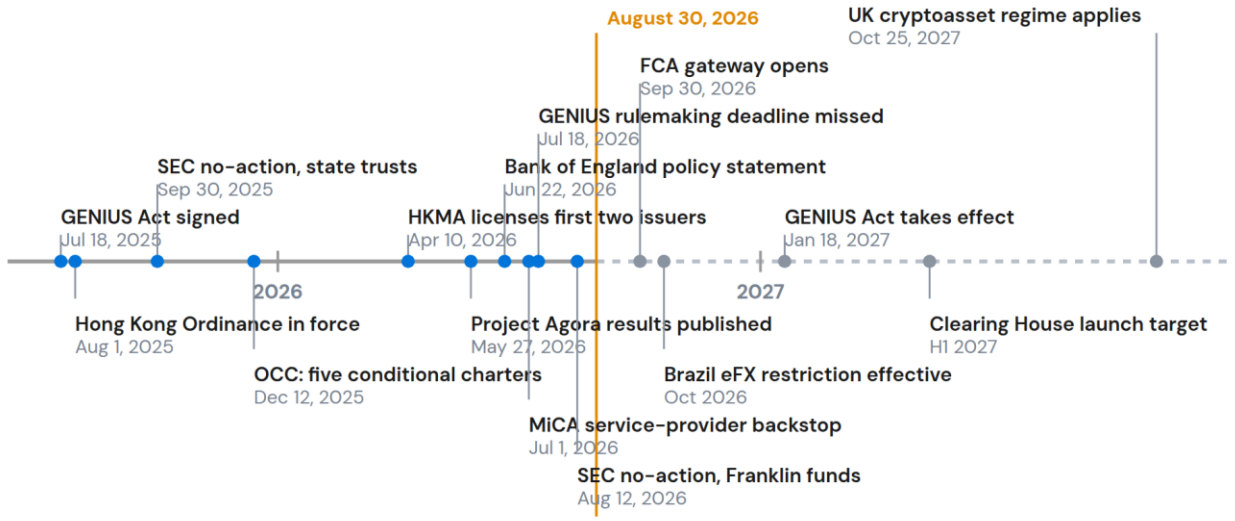
Bank charters. The national trust pipeline is active. Anchorage is operating. Five conditional approvals were granted in December 2025 to Circle, Ripple, BitGo, Fidelity and Paxos; Coinbase followed in April 2026; Circle converted to final approval on July 10, 2026. A trust charter does not take deposits and does not lend.

Market structure. CLARITY has passed the House but not the Senate. The Commission approved Nasdaq's tokenized-equity rule change on March 18, 2026, within a pilot limited to Russell 1000 constituents and major index funds, trading on the same order book against the same CUSIP. DTCC launches its tokenization service in October 2026.

EXHIBIT 4

Eighteen Months of Rulemaking, and the Statute Arrives First

Selected regulatory milestones, July 2025 through October 2027



Sources: Public Law 119-27; *Federal Register*; congress.gov; OCC, SEC, Bank of England, HKMA, Banco Central do Brasil and FCA releases; Bank for International Settlements; company announcements; Al-Mabrook analysis.

03

Where the money moves

Remittance economics as measured rather than assumed, the unbundling of the cross-border stack, and what tokenization has actually delivered.

In this part · 4. Cross-border · 5. Who moved · 6. Tokenization · 7. Custody · Exhibits 5 through 9

Section 4

Cross-border: the thesis, and what the evidence shows

The commercial case rests on a cost comparison, and the average conceals the argument. Sending $200 cost 6.36 percent globally in the third quarter of 2025.[6] Banks charge 14.99 percent; digital channels charge 4.59 percent. Thirteen corridors carry costs above 20 percent. The United Nations target is 3 percent, and no channel meets it.

A stablecoin rail removes the correspondent banking leg and collapses settlement into minutes. That speed advantage is real and not seriously disputed. The cost advantage is where the argument has been overstated, and it has now been measured.

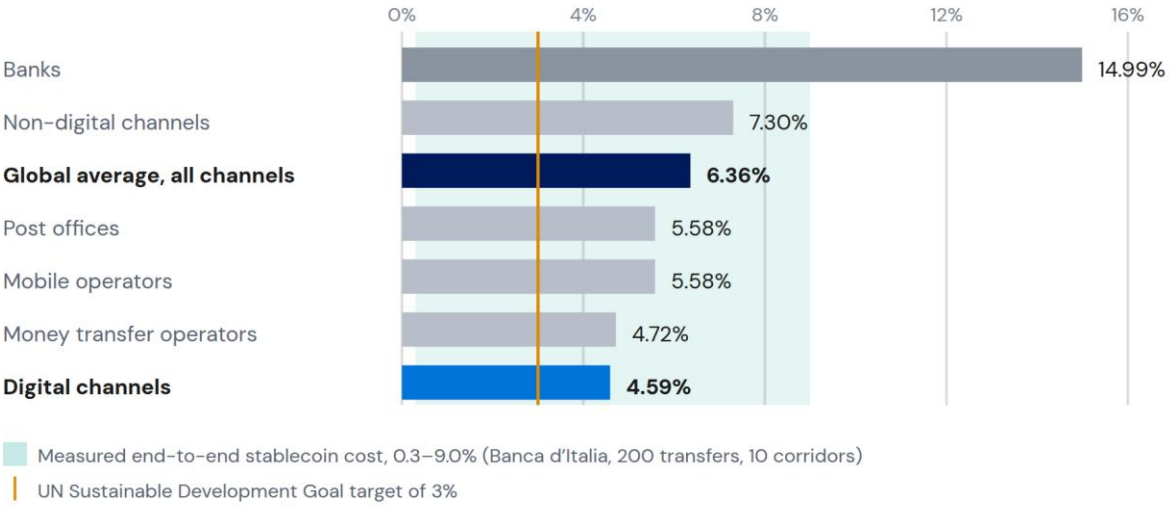
The dispersion within the average is what makes the market attackable. A channel charging 14.99 percent and one charging 4.59 percent serve substantially the same customer under substantially the same obligations, which suggests the gap reflects distribution economics and inertia rather than cost. That is why the incumbents named in section 5 have moved rather than waited.

It also explains where they have moved. None attacked the digital channel, which is already near the practical floor. They attacked the corridors where cash remains the only viable payout and where the incumbent's own network is the barrier to entry. Exhibit 5 sets the baseline against which any corridor has to be argued; the measured range is set out overleaf.

EXHIBIT 5

No Channel Meets the 3 Percent Target, and the Bank Channel Is Three Times the Digital One

Average total cost of sending $200, percentage of principal, by provider type, third quarter 2025



Sources: World Bank, *Remittance Prices Worldwide*, Issue 54, published April 2026; Banca d'Italia, *Markets, Infrastructures and Payment Systems* paper No. 86, August 2026.

3.3×

The spread between the cost of remitting through a bank and through a digital channel.
World Bank, Remittance Prices Worldwide, Issue 54.

MEASUREMENT NOTE

Thirteen corridors carried costs above 20 percent in the third quarter of 2025, nine of them originating in Sub-Saharan Africa.

Averages hide the corridors where a new rail would matter most.

Section 4 · continued

The Banca d'Italia result

In August 2026 the Banca d'Italia published an exercise in which researchers sent 200 USDC transfers across ten corridors from Italy, measuring the complete journey from euro on-ramp through chain settlement to local-currency payout.[7] End-to-end cost ranged from roughly 0.3 percent to almost 9 percent, and the transfers were not systematically cheaper than conventional money transfer operators. On-chain fees were negligible in every corridor. Cost was dominated by exchange fees, foreign-exchange spreads and domestic cash-out charges, none of which the chain touches.

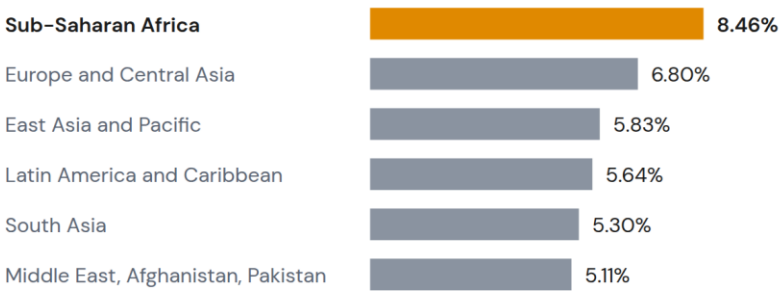
This does not defeat the thesis. It relocates it. The saving exists where local liquidity is deep and an off-ramp already operates, and it is absent where neither holds, which is frequently where the incumbent is most expensive. Underwrite each corridor on measured cost, and expect any generic sub-1 percent claim to have this paper read back to it.

Regional dispersion is the reason corridor selection matters more than rail selection. Sub-Saharan Africa remains the most expensive receiving region at 8.46 percent, some 65 percent above the cheapest. A rail that saves 200 basis points is transformative in one corridor and immaterial in another.

EXHIBIT 6

Sub-Saharan Africa Remains the Most Expensive Destination

Average cost of sending $200, by receiving region, third quarter 2025



Source: World Bank, *Remittance Prices Worldwide*, Issue 54.

> "On-chain fees were negligible. Cost was dominated by everything the chain does not touch."
>
> Banca d'Italia, 200 transfers, ten corridors

Section 4 · continued

Sizing the opportunity without overstating it

Global remittance flows reached $905 billion in 2024, of which $685 billion went to low- and middle-income countries.[8] These two figures are routinely conflated, and the difference between them is larger than most corridor businesses. Within that total, Flagship Advisory Partners sizes the digital person-to-person remittance market at $455 billion, with a current stablecoin share of 3 to 4 percent and an addressable slice of roughly $295 billion.[9]

The same analysis puts cross-border business-to-business flow at $35 trillion, of which roughly $22 trillion is described as structurally contestable, against a present stablecoin share below half a percent. That is where the arithmetic is most favorable and where the least attention is being paid.

What a corridor business actually requires

The institutions that have made this work did not build a crypto remittance application. They assembled four capabilities and treated the token as plumbing: licensed issuance, or issuance tightly contracted to a licensed party; regulated custody of the reserve; corridor-specific on-ramps and off-ramps spanning cash agents, mobile money and bank accounts, which is the expensive part and the part that determines whether the cost advantage exists at all; and a compliance fabric that satisfies GENIUS identification expectations, the MiCA travel rule and correspondent-bank due diligence at once.

Only the third of these is genuinely new, and it is the one most often assumed away in a business case. An institution that already runs a correspondent network has three of the four. An institution that does not is building a payments company, not adding a rail.

> **MEASUREMENT NOTE**
>
> "Global remittances" and "remittances to low- and middle-income countries" differ by $220 billion.
>
> Both figures circulate without qualification. State which one is meant.

$22T

Cross-border business-to-business flow described as structurally contestable, out of $35 trillion.
Flagship Advisory Partners, August 2026.

Section 5

Who moved, and what they actually bought

Three quarters of announcements resolve into one pattern. Value is not accruing to the coin. Issuance is contracted out to licensed specialists, the last mile is defended by incumbents who already own it, and the contested middle, orchestration between on-chain settlement and merchant or treasury workflow, is bought outright.

INSTITUTION	WHAT HAPPENED	WHAT IT SIGNALS
Western Union	USDPT, issued by Anchorage Digital Bank on Solana. Announced October 28, 2025 and launched **May 4, 2026**, with pilots in the Philippines and Bolivia and a cash-out service across a network of more than 500,000 agent locations.	The last mile is the scarce asset. A chartered bank issuer paired with a very large cash network is the template incumbents will copy.
MoneyGram	MGUSD on Stellar, issued by Bridge through M0 contracts, June 2, 2026, with in-app wallets. **Available in the United States only at launch**, against a global network of roughly 500,000 locations.	Branded issuance replacing third-party distribution. Note the gap between the network described in the announcement and the geography actually served.
Mastercard	Agreed to acquire BVNK on March 17, 2026 for up to $1.8 billion including $300 million contingent, and **closed in August 2026**. BVNK moves money across more than 130 countries for Worldpay, Deel and Flywire. Earlier talks with Zerohash ended in January 2026.	Card networks are buying the orchestration layer rather than issuing. The middle of the stack, not the coin.
Stripe, Circle and Visa	Stripe closed Bridge for $1.1 billion in February 2025. OpenPayd went live on the Circle Payments Network on August 25, 2026. Visa joined the Singapore-supported BLOOM initiative the same day, piloting settlement with Nium across seven days a week.	Issuance, compliance, foreign exchange, last-mile cash, card acceptance and treasury orchestration are separating into distinct products with distinct owners.
Qivalis, Agorá and Pangea	Qivalis is thirty-seven European banks under a Dutch e-money license. Project Agorá, run by the Bank for International Settlements with eight central banks and forty-plus private institutions, published results on May 27, 2026 and is moving to real-value testing. Project Pangea is a **Chainlink-led working group**, not a central-bank initiative.	Interoperability is the prize, not a new token. Be precise about which of these are central-bank projects: the governance and the credit risk are not comparable.

Section 6

Tokenization of real-world assets

Tokenization has left the proof-of-concept stage and remains small in stock. Distributed value excluding stablecoins stood at $38.4 billion in late August 2026, roughly double the $19.1 billion recorded at the end of December 2025.[10] Holders grew from 655,000 in January to more than 1.7 million in August, a faster increase than the value itself, which suggests distribution is broadening rather than concentrating.

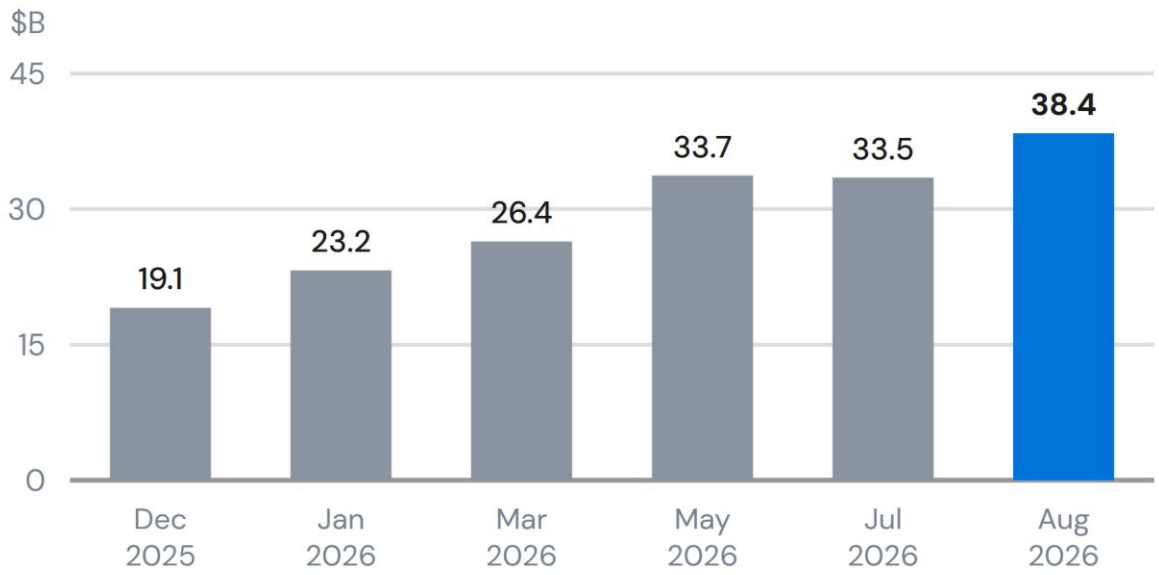
The number requires care. The same market is reported at approximately $31.5 billion on Dune-based counts, and at $365 billion if permissioned inventory measured on a represented rather than distributed basis is included. That is a tenfold range for one phrase. Every figure in this section is on the distributed basis and is not comparable to series published before late 2025, because the trackers changed their methodology.

Growth has also been uneven within the period. Value rose from $19.1 billion to $33.7 billion in the five months to May 2026, then flattened through the summer before adding $5 billion in August. Any projection built on a single quarter of this series will mislead in whichever direction that quarter happened to run.

EXHIBIT 7

Tokenized Value Doubled in Eight Months

Distributed value excluding stablecoins, $ billions



Source: rwa.xyz, via dated coverage.
Note: Distributed basis. Not comparable to series published before the methodology change in late 2025.

MEASUREMENT NOTE

> Three numbers describe the same market on the same day: $31.5 billion, $38.4 billion and $365 billion.
>
> The difference is distributed against represented value, and whether permissioned inventory counts. Name the tracker and the basis, or the figure means nothing.

1.7M

Holders of tokenized real-world assets in August 2026, against 655,000 in January.
rwa.xyz.

Section 6 · continued

Where value is landing

United States Treasury debt is the largest category at $16.2 billion across eighty-seven products, followed by private credit at $7.3 billion and commodities, overwhelmingly gold, at $4.9 billion. Tokenized equities remain the smallest meaningful category at $2.4 billion but are growing fastest, up roughly six times in seven months, with transfer volume rising 138 percent month over month.

The composition matters for how an institution should think about the market. Two-fifths of tokenized value is a cash instrument, and most of the rest is credit or a commodity. Very little of it is the equity market that most tokenization narratives lead with.

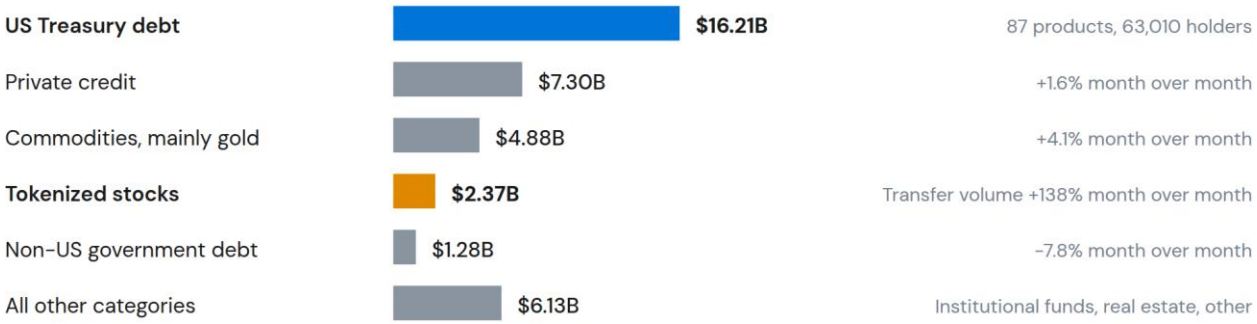
Read that against the forecasts in exhibit 10 and a tension appears. Citi's base case for 2030 puts $3.6 trillion of the $5.5 trillion total in public equities, a category that today accounts for six percent of tokenized value and depends on a market-structure question that regulators have only begun to answer. The forecasts are not implausible, but they require a change in the mix rather than a continuation of it.

The categories that have grown without a rule change are the ones where tokenization solves an operational problem the holder already has: collateral that has to move overnight, fund interests that are expensive to service, and gold that is expensive to store and settle. That is the pattern to underwrite against.

EXHIBIT 8

Treasury Debt Is Two-Fifths of Tokenized Value; Equities Are the Fastest Growing

Distributed value by asset category, $ billions, August 2026



Source: rwa.xyz; Al-Mabrook analysis.

LIQUIDITY, OR ITS ABSENCE

Issuance and secondary trading are not the same market. Analysis published in mid-2026 identified roughly $32.9 billion of tokenized assets recording zero weekly transfers.

Underwrite these programs on servicing and collateral efficiency first, and on trading liquidity second, if at all.

Section 6 · continued

The cash and collateral leg is where institutional adoption is real

Circle's USYC grew from $517 million to $3.0 billion over twelve months and passed BlackRock's BUIDL, which grew more slowly from an already large base. Ondo's USDY and Franklin's BENJI both roughly tripled. The category as a whole reached $15 to $16 billion, having roughly doubled year over year.

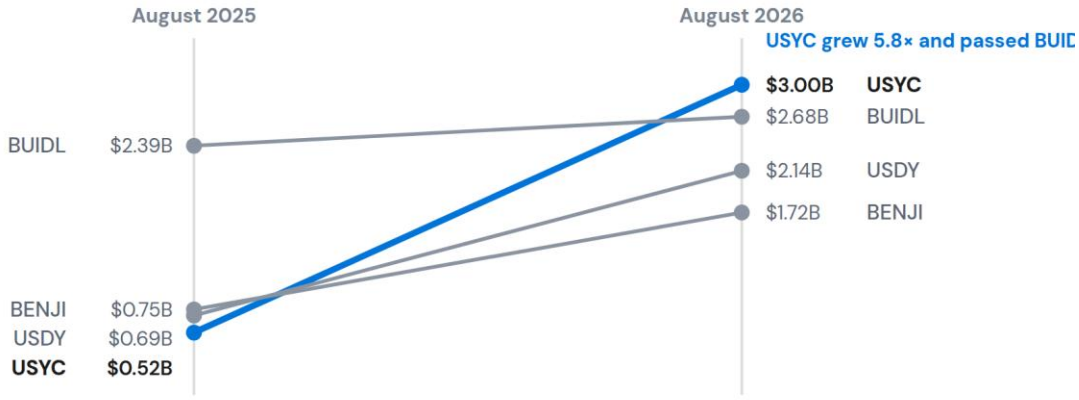
The growth is not evenly distributed, and the reason is instructive. USYC's expansion tracks its adoption as collateral rather than as an investment: it is used to post margin, and margin has to be posted whether or not anyone finds the wrapper interesting. Funds sold as an allocation have grown more slowly than funds sold as plumbing.

Traditional managers have moved into the same space. Fidelity and State Street both launched money market funds aligned to the GENIUS reserve requirements in June 2026. Invesco filed for a tokenized stablecoin-reserve fund on June 25 and has not launched it. The Securities and Exchange Commission's no-action letter of August 12, 2026, which permits Franklin's registered funds and exchange-traded funds to hold shares of its tokenized government money fund, is the structural development that matters most, because it is the bridge into conventional fund assets and it is template-setting for every other manager.

EXHIBIT 9

Circle's USYC Grew Nearly Sixfold and Passed BlackRock's BUIDL

Assets under management, four largest tokenized US Treasury and money market funds, $ billions



Source: rwa.xyz treasury data, August 2025 and August 2026.

Section 6 · continued

The binding constraint is the cash leg

Legal advisers keep returning to the same diagnosis. Writing in January 2026, Ashurst identified the unresolved problem for digital securities as the cash leg, meaning the transformation of fiat into digital value for the payment side of an on-chain transaction, inside what it called a multi-moneyverse of stablecoins, central-bank digital currencies and tokenized deposits that do not interoperate.[11] Securities issuance is progressing. Atomic delivery against payment is not, unless the cash sits on the same or an interoperable ledger. That is why every serious tokenization program now has a money strategy rather than a securities strategy, and it is why the two halves of this report are one subject.

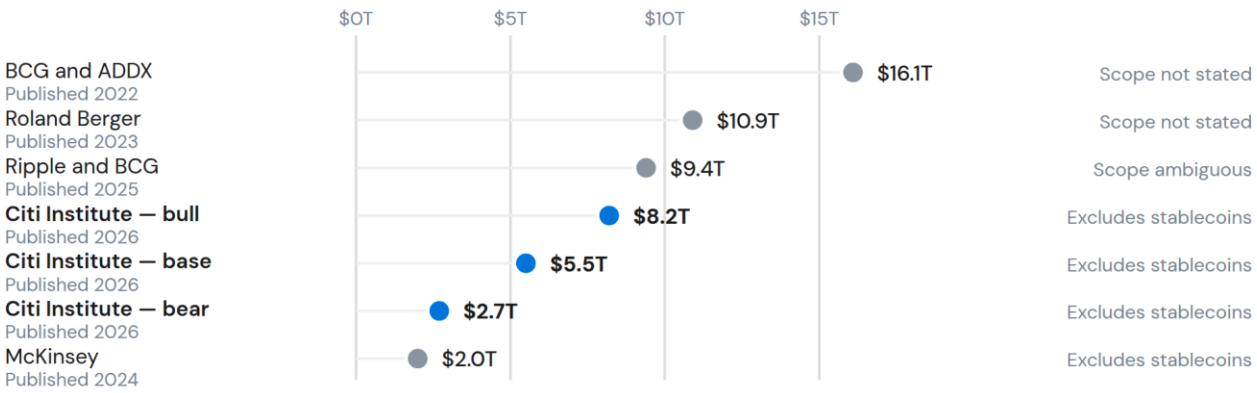
Forecasts, and how to read them

The 2030 forecasts in circulation span $2 trillion to $16 trillion, and the spread is mostly definitional. Citi's June 2026 base case of $5.5 trillion excludes stablecoins entirely and assumes 3 percent tokenization of public equities and 10 percent of Treasury bills. The $16.1 trillion figure still quoted in decks comes from a 2022 BCG and ADDX exercise on a broader scope. The $9.4 trillion figure is from a separate Ripple and BCG study published in April 2025; it is not a revision of the earlier number, although it is frequently presented as one.

EXHIBIT 10

Published Forecasts for 2030 Differ Mostly on Scope, Not on Direction

Projected tokenized real-world asset value in 2030, $ trillions, by publishing house and year of publication



Sources: Citi Institute, *Wall Street On-Chain: Tokenization 2030*, June 2026; Ripple and BCG, April 2025; BCG and ADDX, 2022; Roland Berger, 2023; McKinsey, 2024.

Note: Standard Chartered's $30.1 trillion projection is excluded because it targets 2034. The Ripple and BCG figure is a separate study, not a revision of the BCG and ADDX number.

A FORECAST IS A SCOPE STATEMENT

Before comparing two tokenization forecasts, establish three things: the target year, whether stablecoins sit inside the number, and whether permissioned inventory counts.

Most published comparisons fail all three tests. Standard Chartered's $30.1 trillion projection, for instance, targets 2034.

Section 7

Custody, fiduciary duty and the institutional stack

Custody is the gate that turns a digital-asset strategy from a slide into a bookable position, and the American shift over 2025 and 2026 is the most consequential operating change in a decade. The sequence matters more than the individual items, because several institutions have dated it wrongly and understated their own runway as a result.

Staff Accounting Bulletin 121, which forced banks to gross up custodied cryptoassets on the balance sheet and made custody uneconomic, was rescinded by Bulletin 122 on **January 23, 2025**, effective the following week. This is a 2025 event. Comptroller of the Currency interpretive letter 1170 had permitted national-bank crypto custody since July 2020; letter 1183 in March 2025 reaffirmed custody, node operation and stablecoin activity and removed the supervisory non-objection precondition; letter 1184 in May 2025 permitted fiduciary and non-fiduciary custody, buying and selling at customer direction, and the use of sub-custodians. The Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation rescinded its prior-notification requirement in March 2025 and the Federal Reserve withdrew its supervisory letters in April 2025.

The practical effect of that sequence is easy to understate. For roughly three years a bank that wanted to custody cryptoassets faced a balance-sheet treatment that made the business uneconomic, a requirement to obtain supervisory non-objection before starting, and no clarity on whether it could appoint a sub-custodian. All three obstacles were removed within fifteen months, and none of them was removed by the GENIUS Act.

Supervision has therefore moved from permission to examination, measured against the interagency safekeeping statement of July 2025. Private law has followed, although unevenly. Uniform Commercial Code Article 12, covering controllable electronic records, together with Article 9 control-based perfection, is now the working path for taking security over custodied cryptoassets, and it has been adopted in roughly two-thirds of states plus the District of Columbia. A multi-state collateral opinion still requires a jurisdiction-by-jurisdiction check.

> “Supervision moved from permission to examination.”
>
> Prior-notification requirements withdrawn, 2025

A STRUCTURE WORTH READING CORRECTLY

Institutional tokenized funds separate roles that a single "custodian" label obscures.

In BlackRock's BUIDL, BNY is custodian of fund assets and fund administrator; Securitize is transfer agent and tokenization platform; and token-level custody sits with four firms, Anchorage, BitGo, Coinbase and Fireblocks.

Map all three layers when benchmarking.

Section 7 · continued

Four operating models, and what goes wrong with each

MODEL	WHEN IT FITS	WHAT TO WATCH
National bank or federal savings association as custodian	The institution already holds the relationship, the capital and the examination posture, and the client wants a single balance-sheet view.	Key-ceremony maturity, anti-money-laundering typology for on-chain flow, insurance, and the bankruptcy remoteness of wallets.
National trust charter	A specialist platform that needs a federal answer to the question of who regulates it, without taking deposits.	A trust charter is not a bank and must never be marketed as carrying deposit insurance. Of the five conditional approvals granted in December 2025, only Circle has converted to final approval.
State-chartered trust as qualified custodian	An adviser or fund complex needing a qualified custodian under the Advisers Act and the Investment Company Act, following the staff no-action letter of September 30, 2025.	The relief is staff-level and fact-specific, conditioned on diligence, audited financials, systems reporting, disclosure and a custody agreement barring rehypothecation. It drew a public dissent from a Commissioner.
Bank with a specialist sub-custodian	The fastest route for most regional and mid-size institutions, expressly contemplated by interpretive letter 1184.	Third-party risk, concentration among a short list of infrastructure providers, portability of keys, and who holds legal control under Article 12 against an Article 8 securities-account analysis.

ONE OF FIVE

Of the five national trust charters granted conditional approval in December 2025, only Circle has converted to final approval, on July 10, 2026. Conditional approval is a stage in a process, not an outcome, and it should not be described to a client or a board as a license.

The choice between these is usually made on speed and then defended on principle. It is worth making it the other way around, because the model determines who is examinable, who is liable on a key-management failure, and whether the institution can move providers without moving assets.

Section 8

Payment stablecoins against tokenized deposits

This is the fork every bank chief executive is being asked to choose. For most diversified franchises the answer is a sequenced both, and the sequencing is the strategy.

	PAYMENT STABLECOIN	TOKENIZED DEPOSIT
Legal nature	A claim on the reserve pool of a non-bank or specially chartered issuer. Under GENIUS: permitted issuer, full liquid reserves, redemption at par, no holder interest.	Commercial-bank money on a ledger, remaining on the issuing bank's balance sheet. The deposit-insurance analysis follows the deposit, not the token format.
Who is building	Circle; Tether, including USAT, launched January 27, 2026 through Anchorage; SG-FORGE, with BNY as reserve custodian; Western Union; MoneyGram; Qivalis; the two Hong Kong licensees.	JPMorgan, Citi, Bank of America and Wells Fargo with a broader cohort through The Clearing House, announced June 5, 2026 for launch in the first half of 2027. Swift's shared ledger has been ready since July 9, 2026, with seventeen banks preparing pilots.
Where it wins	Open-network reach, the emerging-market last mile, continuous settlement, fintech embedding, card-scheme orchestration.	Wholesale flow between regulated counterparties, atomic delivery against payment inside the banking system, examiner comfort, and reuse of existing credit limits.
Official-sector view	Licensed and constrained, with hard reserve, anti-money-laundering and no-yield requirements. The Settlements bank holds the current form is not credible for payments at scale.	Preferred by the Settlements bank and many central banks as the route to bring tokenization inside the two-tier monetary system, settling in central-bank money.
Franchise risk	Deposit substitution if convenience pulls operating balances off the bank; operational, reputational and sanctions exposure if used as a correspondent substitute.	Build cost, and interoperability risk if each bank's token cannot leave its own network. Slow to reach the long tail of corporates and consumers.

WHAT WOULD STRENGTHEN EACH CASE

For stablecoins: final GENIUS rules and a published examination manual; redemption at par demonstrated under stress; corridor economics measured end to end and shown to beat incumbents consistently; working interoperability across the three major regimes.

For tokenized deposits: The Clearing House launching on schedule with more than its lead banks live; Swift moving from pilots to production volume; and a credible answer on reach, because deposit tokens serve regulated counterparties rather than the corridors where the cost problem lives.

OUR VIEW

Accept and custody the major dollar stablecoins for clients who already hold them. Participate in the deposit-token design work for wholesale, and document a decision to decline rather than letting it happen by default.

Run one or two named corridors with a licensed issuer rather than launching a branded coin. Reserve any issuance decision for 2027, once rules and examination manuals are final.

This describes how the market is sequencing these choices. It is not a recommendation to any particular institution.

Section 9

Risk register for the executive committee

RISK	HEAT	WHY IT IS LIVE IN THE SECOND HALF OF 2026
Rulebook gap	High	GENIUS is law and most implementing rules are not. The rulemaking deadline passed in July 2026. Building to the statute is necessary; building as though every proposal were final is not. Vendor and issuance contracts need re-trade provisions through January 2027.
Reserve and run risk	Medium	Full cash and Treasury-bill backing with no holder interest reduces redemption-wave risk without eliminating it. Float has contracted $16 billion from its May peak, a reminder that supply moves in both directions.
Anti-money-laundering typology	High	The joint customer-identification proposal closed for comment on August 21, 2026. Travel-rule compliance, wallet attribution and off-ramp verification will be the examination focus, not the policy.
Interoperability failure	Medium	A world of GENIUS dollars, MiCA e-money tokens, Hong Kong coins, Qivalis euros and Clearing House deposit tokens that cannot compose is a more expensive correspondent system. Agorá, Swift and Pangea each attack this from a different direction.
Jurisdiction whiplash	Medium	Brazil's October 2026 restriction is instructive for its shape: one licensing channel closed while another stayed open. Corridor planning that treats regulation as binary will misread this in both directions.
Technology and key operations	High	Fork handling, upgrade authority, key architecture, disaster recovery of seed material and vendor concentration across a short list of providers belong on the operational risk dashboard, not in a technology appendix.
Accounting and capital	Medium	Bulletin 122 improved custody economics. The treatment of tokenized deposits, in-kind redemption of tokenized funds, and stablecoin reserves still requires accounting policy memoranda signed by the controller and the external auditor.
Conduct and disclosure	Medium	Clients will confuse non-interest-bearing stablecoins with yield-bearing tokenized money market funds, and the Bank of England has now permitted activity-based

RISK	HEAT	WHY IT IS LIVE IN THE SECOND HALF OF 2026
		rewards, adding a third category. Product maps and sales scripts need legal sign-off before rollout.
Shariah governance uncertainty	High	No AAOIFI standard on digital assets exists, mainstream screening does not cover tokenized real-world assets, and no settled purification methodology exists for tokenized yield. A governance exposure, not a theological debate. See section 10.

THE FAILURE MODE WE SEE MOST

Not choosing the wrong rail. Running a pilot with no pre-agreed success metric, so that it can neither be scaled nor killed. Eighteen months later the institution discovers either that the corridor economics never worked, or that they did and nobody held the mandate to act.

Section 10

An Islamic finance lens on tokenization

SCOPE OF THIS SECTION

This section describes observable market, regulatory and governance facts. It is not a Shariah opinion, ruling, audit or certification, and it does not determine that any asset, instrument, structure, protocol, token or institution is or is not Shariah compliant. Shariah determination is a matter for a qualified Shariah supervisory board applying the standards adopted by the relevant institution and jurisdiction.

Islamic finance holds approximately $5.98 trillion in assets, forecast to reach $9.7 trillion by 2029, with more than $1 trillion of sukuk outstanding at the end of 2025.[12] Against a $38.4 billion global tokenized asset market, the sector's on-chain footprint is close to a rounding error. Total tokenized sukuk issuance stands at roughly $25 million, from a single RM100 million wakalah bi al-istithmar transaction executed by Khazanah with the Securities Commission Malaysia in April 2026.

The asymmetry is worth stating plainly. Roughly a quarter of the world's population, a low single-digit percentage of global financial assets, and a fraction of one percent of tokenized value.

Three explanations circulate for the gap, and they are not mutually exclusive. The first is distribution: sukuk are held to maturity by institutions that have no operational problem tokenization solves. The second is governance, discussed below. The third is that the sector's growth has been comfortable enough that no issuer has needed to reach for a new mechanism.

Where demonstrated demand sits

Tokenized gold is the largest live category at approximately $5.2 billion across XAUT and PAXG, with $90.7 billion of spot volume in the first quarter of 2026. Dubai's Land Department, working with PRYPCO Mint, tokenized AED 18.5 million of property in its first phase, opened a secondary market in February 2026 and projects roughly $16 billion by 2033. Environmental and social sukuk stand at approximately $58 billion outstanding, forecast above $70 billion by the end of 2026 and representing roughly 40 percent of emerging-market sustainable debt. Commodity murabaha, at approximately $512 billion of deposits and $380 billion of financing, has exactly the operational cost profile that tokenization addresses, and remains at concept stage on chain with no live sized issuance.

$25M

Total tokenized sukuk issued to date, against more than $1 trillion of sukuk outstanding.
Khazanah and Securities Commission Malaysia, April 2026.

CONFLICTING TOTALS

Islamic finance assets are reported at $5.98 trillion by ICD–LSEG and $3.88 trillion by the Islamic Financial Services Board.

The institutional universes differ. Never present both figures in the same document without saying so.

Section 10 · continued

The governance gap, evidenced

No AAOIFI standard on digital assets or tokenization exists as of 2026. The subject has been discussed at conference level and has not produced a standard. The joint AAOIFI and Islamic Financial Services Board revised Shariah governance framework, issued in exposure draft, contains no mention of digital assets, blockchain or financial technology. Shariah Standard 62 on sukuk was placed on hold indefinitely in November 2025 following issuer and investor objection.

The difficulty is not confined to novel instruments. Screening methodologies diverge materially on conventional equities: one vendor analysis published in July 2026 found that 22.4 percent of the S&P 500 receives contradictory verdicts across five major methodologies, with only 37.9 percent passing all five.[13] No mainstream screener covers tokenized real-world assets. No settled purification methodology exists for tokenized yield. Post-issuance Shariah audit is required almost nowhere, the Central Bank of Bahrain's stablecoin module being a rare exception.

Revealed preference is telling. Khazanah's tokenized sukuk disclosed no Shariah adviser. Dubai's tokenized real estate program makes no Shariah claim at all.

What this means operationally

An Islamic financial institution cannot presently point to a standard-setter's rulebook for digital assets, because none exists. Governance therefore has to be built at the institution level: a documented screening methodology for digital and tokenized exposures; a named Shariah supervisory board that has reviewed the on-chain structure rather than only the underlying asset; a purification policy for any yield-bearing tokenized instrument; and a post-issuance audit trail. Institutions that build this now will be ahead of the standard when it arrives. Institutions that wait will be retrofitting governance onto live positions, which is materially harder and considerably more expensive.

There is also a competitive dimension. The institutions that resolve this first will be the ones other institutions route through, in the same way that a small number of custodians became the route through which conventional institutions accessed the market. Governance capability, in a market with no standard, is a distribution advantage rather than a compliance cost.

This is an observation about market practice. The design of any such framework is a matter for qualified Shariah and legal counsel, and nothing in this section should be read as a view on the permissibility of any structure described.

> “Khazanah's tokenized sukuk disclosed no Shariah adviser. Dubai's tokenized real estate program makes no Shariah claim at all.”

NOT USED IN THIS REPORT

Claims that AAOIFI has ruled on cryptoassets; a reported HSBC Amanah tokenized sukuk; ADIB's Smart Sukuk described as tokenization; and Saudi digital-asset Shariah guidelines said to have been issued in 2024.

None could be substantiated against a primary source.

Section 11

A ninety-day agenda, and the questions that test it

The sequence below reflects how institutions are scoping this work in 2026. It is offered as a planning structure rather than as advice on any particular institution's circumstances.

Days 1 to 30 — govern and baseline

1. Name a single executive owner, with payments and treasury as co-sponsors and risk as second line, and convene a fortnightly operating committee including legal, financial crime, finance, operations and technology.
2. Inventory every current exposure: client holdings, proprietary positions, vendor contracts, seed investments in tokenized funds, card-scheme pilots and remittance partnerships. Most institutions find more than they expected.
3. Commission an applicability memorandum across GENIUS, MiCA and the Hong Kong Ordinance. Is the institution an issuer, a distributor, a custodian, or an acceptor? The answer drives the entire licensing map.

Days 31 to 60 — design the rails

1. Select two corridors, one remittance and one business payable, and one wholesale use case such as intraday collateral or a tokenized money market fund as a cash sleeve. Stop everything else for this cycle.
2. Model each corridor on measured end-to-end cost including on-ramp, foreign-exchange spread and local cash-out. The Banca d'Italia range is the benchmark to beat and it will be quoted back.
3. Choose the custody architecture and run a third-party risk assessment against the July 2025 interagency safekeeping statement.
4. Decide the 2027 posture on tokenized deposits: observer, founding participant or decline. Record the reasoning, because it will be revisited.

Days 61 to 90 — put one thing into production

5. Launch a controlled pilot with pre-agreed metrics: cost per payment against wire, time to finality, exception rate, alert quality, client satisfaction, and capital and liquidity impact.
6. Approve accounting policy, product disclosure and incident-response playbooks covering depeg, chain halt, vendor outage, sanctions hit and fork, before the pilot goes live.
7. Brief the board with a one-page capital and earnings sensitivity using the institution's own numbers rather than the industry's.

SEVEN QUESTIONS FOR THE BOARD

1. If regulated dollars become the default on-chain cash, do we issue, distribute or only custody, and who owns the income statement?

2. What share of correspondent and remittance revenue is exposed if settlement moves to same day?

3. Are we inside the deposit-token design work, or a price-taker on someone else's ledger in 2027?

4. Would our qualified-custodian story survive an examination and a bankruptcy-remoteness review in the same week?

5. Which three clients leave within a year if a competitor offers continuous programmable dollars with the same credit officer?

6. When a rulebook turns against us mid-pilot, what is the kill switch and who may use it?

7. For Islamic institutions: absent any standard, what is our own documented governance, and has the Shariah board reviewed the on-chain structure?

Method and corrections

About this study

This report synthesizes primary official-sector material, named institutional research and company announcements of record, current as of August 30, 2026. Every quantitative claim carries a source and an as-of date. Where reputable houses publish materially different figures for the same measure, the report shows the range and names the basis of measurement. No token, issuer, protocol or venue is recommended, and the report contains no price forecast.

Three measurement conflicts that affect this subject

Stablecoin transfer volume has two incompatible bases. Artemis reports a thirty-day adjusted figure; Visa and Allium publish an adjusted figure derived from a filter roughly four times stricter. Plotting them as one series produces an apparent collapse that did not occur.

Tokenized asset value has two bases and three trackers. The distributed measure used throughout this report gave $38.4 billion in late August 2026. Dune-based counts of the same measure gave approximately $31.5 billion. The represented measure, which includes permissioned inventory, gave $365 billion in January 2026. Series published before late 2025 are not comparable.

The ACH comparison is basis-dependent. The widely repeated claim that stablecoin volume surpassed the Automated Clearing House in February 2026 uses an ACH figure of $6.8 trillion for that month. Nacha's published statistics imply $8.3 to $8.6 trillion a month across the first half of 2026.

Figures deliberately excluded

A frequently quoted projection of $1.5 to $2 trillion in tokenized assets by 2030 attributed to Deutsche Bank does not appear in that bank's May 2026 paper on digital money, whose published headline statistics are different. A $2.7 trillion figure for 2025 crypto trading volume commonly attributed to BCG and Allium is a sum of four separate categories in that paper rather than a figure the authors state, and the paper notes that most trading occurs off-chain and is unobservable. Neither is used here.

The title of the Bank for International Settlements address at Jackson Hole could not be confirmed against the institution's own record and is therefore cited by date and venue only.

CORRECTIONS TO PRIOR CIRCULATION

Nine items in an earlier draft circulated internally have been corrected and are reflected in this text.

Bulletin 121 was rescinded in January 2025, not 2026.

The Bank of England dropped per-holder caps and moved backing to 30/70 in June 2026; the 40/60 position described a superseded consultation.

Brazil's measure is a channel restriction, not a general ban.

Global remittances are $905 billion, not $850 billion.

The sub-1 percent remittance cost claim is contradicted by measurement.

USDT and USDC hold 84.6 percent, not 80 to 83 percent.

Project Pangea is an industry working group, not a central-bank project.

A BNY and Fireblocks reference architecture for BUIDL does not exist as described.

Tokenized treasuries are $15 to $16 billion, and USYC has passed BUIDL.

Endnotes

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